What The Sift tells us about Dimensions

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Aspirational Adventures

Minecraft Live, 2026: Lady Agnes saw us off with the following statement: “The Sift is *one* important step on our Aspirational Adventures Journey. But, it is *not the end of it.*”
This hurried statement struck a chord with many that have been wanting an end update.[1] We’ll be waiting longer for that, but that’s probably for the best.

The Sift feels like a fresh, colorful start for the Minecraft of today, as they’ve turned a simple indie block game into something expansive. The Sift belongs to this moment, this decade, in ways that the Nether and End don’t.

Many players avoid the challenges of the Nether and the End, but perhaps The Sift can offer enough new opportunities to break that pattern. New wood types to fill the rest of the 16 color range, new stones, new pets for companions or zoos, new material alternatives to Netherite[2], and new opportunities to expand in ways that Minecraft hasn’t yet.

What players and developers can learn from The Sift and Aspirational Adventures may be takeaways that they need in order to bring the spirit of the new into the old. It’s not the end yet for Minecraft.

New Mobs, a New Groove

Historically, base mobs were introduced quite slowly into the game. Varieties off of base forms are a safe bet, but The Sift is positively vibrant. New passive and hostile wildlife are bound to be present from what we’ve seen in Dungeons 2. It remains to be seen what niches will exist in base Minecraft.

Minecraft Dungeons 2 also provides more bosses, and more lore to the Illagers. It’s too early to assume there will be a direct translation, but perhaps The Sift will provide us new bosses and

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[1] Aphiciency. October 2026. “The Minecraft End Update is REAL!” https://youtube.com/shorts/-KLcF4q0OF8?is=zAMAkBEIdA8mk5iC
[2] Minecraft. April 2021. “Ask Mojang #16: Tools and Gear”. https://youtu.be/ndDttLXhAeE?is=1lS6j5c5H6szeylN

new difficulties without the fear of fire and lava or the void that has kept casual players in the overworld.

Ichor: Nutritious Nectar or Torpid Terror?

It's not quite lava or water, but a mythical substance found in The Sift. In Dungeons 2, it inflicts soulsickness, draining players of health and souls. [3]

There are no 'souls' mechanics in base Minecraft presently. There is room for speculation about the loss of experience as the overworld sculk releases experience. Experience storage is possible for mob farms using a sculk catalyst.

Almost certainly, Ichor will have a technical use, but if The Sift has the 'healthy' version of Skulk and wardens, what does that mean for Ichor transported into other dimensions? Could it behave differently in the overworld?

Conclusion

The Sift presents more questions than answers at this point. The adventures may be aspirational, but I suspect the biggest aspiration might be changing how players think about progression. The End is flawed, and rushing to get the Elytra can break the game. The End isn't what it could be, but a new approach on developing the middle and end game may be what the cleric called for. Perhaps The Sift is another beginning for an aspirational reimagining.

[3] "Dungeons II:Soulsick – Minecraft Wiki." *Minecraft Wiki*, 2026, https://minecraft.wiki/w/Dungeons_II:Soulsick. Accessed 10 Oct. 2026.